

POLITICS

INTRODUCTION

Politics involves the study of how societies are governed, how public policy is developed, and how power is distributed. It also concerns how citizens take public action, working for the common good within communities at the local, national, and/or global level. Political inquiry involves the exploration of political concepts, processes, practices, issues, and trends, and the development of an understanding of the importance of political engagement and how and why the interests and perspectives of stakeholders may differ. Through such inquiry, students clarify and generate support for their own positions on a variety of issues. The study of politics also enables students to develop an understanding of their rights and responsibilities and to explore various elements of the citizenship education framework.

Strands

The Grade 11 politics course has four strands, while the Grade 12 politics course has five strands. In both courses, strand A, Political Inquiry and Skill Development, is followed by content strands, which are organized thematically.

Citizenship Education

The expectations in the Grade 11 and 12 politics courses provide opportunities for students to explore a number of concepts connected to the citizenship education framework (see page 13).

The Concepts of Political Thinking

The four concepts of political thinking – political significance, objectives and results, stability and change, and political perspective – underpin thinking and learning in all politics courses in the Canadian and world studies program. At least one concept of political thinking is identified as the focus for each overall expectation in the content strands of these courses. The following chart describes each concept and provides sample questions related to it. These questions highlight opportunities for students to apply a specific concept in their studies. (See page 16 for a fuller discussion of the concepts of disciplinary thinking.)

Political Significance
This concept requires students to determine the importance of things such as government policies; political or social issues, events, or developments; and the civic actions of individuals and groups. Political significance is generally determined by the impact of a government policy or decision on the lives of citizens, or by the influence that civic action, including the civic action of students, has on political or public decision making. Students develop their understanding that the political significance of something may vary for different groups of people. Related Questions* – Why is it important to understand how political structures and processes work? (CHV2O, Overview) – Why are some issues politically important while others tend to be ignored? (CPC3O, B2.1) – How would you determine the political significance of a government’s decision to call an early election? (CPW4U, A1.5) – Who are some theorists whose ideas are central to postcolonial political thought? What is the significance of their ideas? (CPW4U, B1.2)
Objectives and Results
This concept requires students to determine the factors that lead to events, policies, decisions, and/or plans of action of civic and political importance. It also requires students to analyse the effects of civic and political actions and to recognize that government policies and decisions as well as responses to civic issues can have a range of effects on various groups of people. A comparison of the initial purpose or goals of a policy or decision and its effects enables students to distinguish between intended and unintended results. Related Questions – What was the objective of the UN Declaration of Human Rights? Do all people enjoy the rights embodied in that document? (CHV2O, B3.4) – What are some examples of political actions or policies that have produced unintended results? (CPC3O, A1.5) – What problems were some provinces hoping to solve by adopting the harmonized sales tax (HST)? Did the adoption of the HST solve these problems? (CPC3O, B3.3) – What are some examples of the influence of Canada’s commitment to human rights and democratic values on its foreign policy? What are some examples of the influence of economic considerations on Canada’s foreign policy? (CPW4U, C3.2)

* The “related questions” are drawn directly from the overview charts that precede the Grade 11 and 12 politics courses and from the sample questions that accompany many specific expectations. To highlight the continuity between the politics courses in Grade 11 and 12 and the Grade 10 civics (politics) course, and to show possible development in the use of the concepts of political thinking over those grades, the chart includes some questions from the Grade 10 civics course as well.

Stability and Change

This concept requires students to analyse how and why political institutions and government policies change over time or why they remain the same. Students will determine how political structures and decisions contribute to stability and change within various local, national, and/or global communities. They analyse ways in which various institutions, groups, or individuals resist or support change, as well as how a variety of factors, including civic action, can contribute to change or stability. Students also apply this concept to help them determine when change is necessary and how they themselves can contribute to change, or help ensure stability, through civic action.

Related Questions

- What impact can consumers' choices have on the natural environment? (CHV2O, C1.3)
- Why are people concerned about growing economic inequality, both in Canada and globally? (CPC3O, B3.2)
- How have technological developments such as social media affected the strategies of groups seeking political change? (CPC3O, C3.2)
- How does decolonization continue to affect politics and international relations today? (CPW4U, Overview)

Political Perspective

This concept requires students to analyse the beliefs and values of various groups, including different governments, in local, national, and/or global communities. Students analyse how these beliefs and values, as well as political ideologies, can affect one's position on or response to issues of civic importance. Students also develop their awareness of how stakeholder groups with different perspectives can influence the policies and platforms of political parties and the decisions of governments.

Related Questions

- How important a role do you think the media play in swaying public opinion on social/political issues? Whose opinions do you think the media reflect? (CHV2O, B2.4)
- What facets of your personal identity affect your political orientation? (CPC3O, B1.1)
- How does the relationship of First Nations, Métis, and/or Inuit people with the environment influence their position on some political issues? (CPW4U, B3.6)
- Why might grassroots groups and transnational corporations have different perspectives on how food security should be addressed? (CPW4U, D2.1)

The Political Inquiry Process

In each course in politics in the Canadian and world studies curriculum, strand A focuses explicitly on the political inquiry process, guiding students in their investigation of political issues, events, developments, policies, decisions, concepts, and/or plans of action. This process is *not* intended to be applied in a linear manner: students will use the applicable components of the process in the order most appropriate for them and for the task at hand. Although strand A covers all of the components of the inquiry process, it is important to note that students apply skills associated with the inquiry process throughout the content strands in each course. (See page 32 for a fuller discussion of the inquiry process in the Canadian and world studies program.)

The following chart identifies ways in which students may approach each of the components of the political inquiry process.

Formulate Questions
Students formulate questions: – to explore various issues, developments, concepts, policies, decisions, and/or processes that are related to the overall expectations in order to identify the focus of their inquiry – to help them determine which key concept (or concepts) of political thinking is relevant to their inquiry – that reflect the selected concept(s) of political thinking – to develop criteria that they will use in evaluating policy, data, evidence, and/or information; in making judgements, decisions, or predictions; in reaching conclusions; in solving problems; and/or in formulating and/or evaluating plans of action
Gather and Organize
Students: – collect relevant qualitative and quantitative data, evidence, and/or information from a variety of primary and secondary sources,^a including visuals^b and community resources^c – determine if their sources are credible, accurate, and reliable – identify the purpose and intent of each source – identify the points of view in the sources they have gathered – use a variety of methods to organize the data, evidence, and/or information they have gathered – record the sources of the data, evidence, and/or information they are using – decide whether they have collected enough data, evidence, and/or information for their inquiry

a. Primary sources may include, but are not limited to, census data, interviews, legislation, letters, photographs, policy documents, speeches, and treaties. Secondary sources may include, but are not limited to, documentaries and other films, editorials, news articles, political cartoons, reference books, song lyrics, and works of art. Depending on the context, digital sources, including social media and websites, can be either primary or secondary sources.

b. Visuals may include, but are not limited to, photographs, media clips, maps, models, graphs, and diagrams.

c. Community resources may include, but are not limited to, a range of resources from community groups and associations, government offices, and non-governmental organizations.

Interpret and Analyse

Students:

- analyse data, evidence, and/or information, applying the relevant concepts of political thinking (see preceding chart)
- use different types of tools to help them interpret and analyse their data, evidence, and/or information
- identify the key points or ideas in each source
- interpret data and representations of data (e.g., graphs, charts, diagrams, statistical tables) to help them analyse issues, events, developments, policies, practices, and/or decisions
- construct graphs, charts, and/or diagrams to help them analyse the issue, event, development, policy, practices, and/or decision they are investigating and/or the plan of action they are developing
- analyse their sources to determine the importance of an issue, event, development, plan of action, policy, practice, decision, and/or outcome for communities, individuals, and/or groups, including different groups
- identify biases in individual sources
- determine if all points of view are represented in the source materials as a whole, and which, if any, are missing

Evaluate and Draw Conclusions

Students:

- synthesize data, evidence, and/or information, and make informed, critical judgements based on that data, evidence, and/or information
- make connections between different factors and contexts when analysing issues, events, developments, policies, practices, and/or decisions
- determine the short- and long-term impact of issues, events, developments, policies, practices, and/or decisions on different individuals, communities, groups, and/or regions
- assess the ethical implications of issues, policies, practices, decisions, and/or plans of action
- reach conclusions about the subject of their inquiry, and support them with their data, evidence, and/or information
- make predictions based on their data, evidence, and/or information
- use criteria to determine appropriate forms of action and/or to evaluate the impact of a plan of action

Communicate

Students:

- use appropriate forms (e.g., oral, visual, written, multimedia) for different audiences and purposes
- communicate their arguments, conclusions, predictions, and/or plans of action clearly and logically
- use terminology and concepts related to politics and citizenship education correctly and effectively
- cite sources, using appropriate forms of documentation

Politics in Action: Making Change, Grade 11

Open

CPC30

This course enables students to develop plans for change in the local, national, and/or global community. Students will explore various issues, investigating their causes as well as their impact, and determining where change is needed, and why. They will examine the effectiveness of various problem-solving strategies used by individuals and groups that have brought about and/or are attempting to bring about political change in democratic societies. In addition, students will analyse the role and perspectives of governments and other stakeholders in relation to issues of political importance and will consider factors affecting their own and others' political engagement. Students will apply the concepts of political thinking and the political inquiry process as they investigate various issues of political importance and develop a plan of action to address a selected issue.

Prerequisite: Civics and Citizenship, Grade 10, Open

OVERVIEW

The course has four strands. Instruction and learning related to the expectations in strand A are to be interwoven with instruction and learning related to expectations from the other three strands. Strand A must not be seen as independent of the other strands. Student achievement of the expectations in strand A is to be assessed and evaluated *throughout* the course.

Strand A

A. Political Inquiry and Skill Development
Overall Expectations
A1. Political Inquiry: use the political inquiry process and the concepts of political thinking when investigating issues of political importance in various communities and ways to address them
A2. Developing Transferable Skills: apply in everyday contexts skills developed through investigations related to politics, and identify some careers in which a background in political studies might be an asset

(continued)

Overview *(continued)*

Throughout this course, when planning instruction, teachers should weave the expectations from strand A in with the expectations from strands B–D.

Strands B–D

Overall Expectations and Related Concepts of Political Thinking	Big Ideas*	Framing Questions*
B. Foundations of Political Engagement		
B1. Factors Affecting Political Engagement: analyse how various factors can contribute to, and present a barrier to, their own and others' political engagement (FOCUS ON: <i>Political Significance; Political Perspective</i>)	Personal identity and experiences can affect an individual's political interests. People have different levels of privilege and political power, which can affect their political engagement.	How are your interest in politics and your political actions influenced by your own identity and experiences? What factors contribute to a person's interest and involvement in politics? What factors might limit that interest or involvement? Who determines political priorities?
B2. Issues of Political Importance: explain the political importance of some current issues and analyse various perspectives associated with these issues (FOCUS ON: <i>Political Significance; Political Perspective</i>)	Some current issues are more politically important than others.	
B3. Causes, Impact, and Solutions: analyse some issues of political importance in terms of their causes, their impact, and ways in which they have been addressed (FOCUS ON: <i>Objectives and Results; Stability and Change</i>)	The causes of political issues are complex and multifaceted. Political solutions can have intended and unintended results.	What is fair in politics?
C. Policy, Politics, and Democratic Change		
C1. The Influence of Individuals and Groups: analyse the objectives and strategies, and assess the influence, of individuals and groups in addressing issues of political importance (FOCUS ON: <i>Objectives and Results; Political Perspective</i>)	Individuals, groups, and the media have the ability to make political change.	How does the level of political involvement of citizens affect a democracy?
C2. Law and Policy in Canada: analyse the impact of some key changes in Canadian law and policy as well as the process for changing laws in Canada (FOCUS ON: <i>Objectives and Results; Stability and Change</i>)	Canadian law and political policies change over time. Canadian law and political policy are rooted in democratic principles.	Are Canadian laws and political policies fair and equitable?
C3. Political Change in Democratic Societies: demonstrate an understanding of factors that facilitate and present challenges to democratic political change (FOCUS ON: <i>Political Significance; Political Perspective</i>)	Democracy relies on the political action of individuals and groups. Diverse political opinions sustain a democracy.	How does political change happen in a democracy?

* See page 17 for a discussion of the purpose of big ideas and framing questions.

Overall Expectations and Related Concepts of Political Thinking	Big Ideas*	Framing Questions*
D. Personal Action on a Political Issue		
D1. Investigating an Issue: identify and analyse a political issue, with the goal of developing a personal plan of action to address this issue (FOCUS ON: <i>Political Significance; Political Perspective</i>)	The interest and commitment of individuals and groups drives political change. There are multiple points of view on every political issue.	What political problems particularly concern you? Why? Do other people or groups feel the same way about these problems? What factors do you need to consider when deciding how a problem should be addressed? Whose viewpoints should you consider?
D2. Developing a Plan of Action: identify a goal associated with the selected issue and construct an action plan to achieve that goal (FOCUS ON: <i>Objectives and Results; Political Perspective</i>)	A plan of action must be practical.	Who will benefit from a proposed solution to a problem? Will anyone be adversely affected by it?
D3. Considering Outcomes: analyse and reflect on possible outcome(s) of their plan (FOCUS ON: <i>Objectives and Results; Stability and Change</i>)	Formulating a plan of action includes making reasoned predictions about its possible outcomes.	

A. POLITICAL INQUIRY AND SKILL DEVELOPMENT

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

Throughout this course, students will:

- A1. Political Inquiry:** use the political inquiry process and the concepts of political thinking when investigating issues of political importance in various communities and ways to address them;
- A2. Developing Transferable Skills:** apply in everyday contexts skills developed through investigations related to politics, and identify some careers in which a background in political studies might be an asset.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

A1. Political Inquiry

Throughout this course, students will:

- A1.1** formulate different types of questions to guide investigations into issues of political importance in various communities and ways to address them (*e.g.*, factual questions: *How many people use food banks in my community?*; comparative questions: *What criteria could I use to evaluate the effectiveness of different strategies used to try to bring about political change?*; causal questions: *What are some factors that contribute to economic inequality?*)

- A1.2** select and organize relevant evidence, data, and information on issues of political importance and ways to address them from a variety of primary and secondary sources (*e.g.*, primary: *interviews, photographs, speeches, statistics, surveys*; secondary: *documentaries and other films, news stories, political cartoons, textbooks, websites*), ensuring that their sources reflect different perspectives

Sample questions: “What type of statistics might help you determine the impact of this issue on different groups? Where might you find such statistics?” “What individuals or groups could provide informed opinion about the short- and long-term effects of this policy?”

- A1.3** assess the credibility of sources relevant to their investigations (*e.g.*, *the reliability of the evidence presented in a source; the purpose, intended audience, and context of a source; the bias, values, and expertise of the speaker/author*)

Sample questions: “What criteria might you use to help you determine which sources are credible?” “Is the evidence that this person uses to support his or her opinion on this issue reliable? Is it convincing? Can it be easily refuted?”

- A1.4** interpret and analyse evidence, data, and information relevant to their investigations using various tools, strategies, and approaches that are appropriate for political inquiry (*e.g.*, *use a 5Ws chart to help them analyse information they have gathered; use a web chart to record the points of view of different stakeholders; assess the validity and rank the importance of various points made in their sources; collaborate with their peers to discuss, clarify, and compare positions on an issue*)

Sample questions: “What type of diagram could you use to show the relative importance of the factors that contribute to homelessness?” “What headings might you use in this chart to categorize the positions of stakeholders on this issue?”

- A1.5** use the concepts of political thinking (*i.e.*, political significance, objectives and results, stability and change, and political perspective) when analysing and evaluating evidence, data, and information and formulating conclusions and/or judgements about issues of political importance in various communities and ways to address them (*e.g.*, *use the concept of political significance when determining the impact of a change in foreign aid policy; take the concept of objectives and results into consideration when analysing arguments for and against higher or lower taxes; use the concept of stability and change*)

to help them evaluate arguments for and against a proposal to establish a green belt around an urban area; apply the concept of political perspective to help them explain a government response to a reform movement)

Sample questions: “What are some examples of political actions or policies that have produced unintended results?” “How might applying the concept of stability and change help you determine whether there is a need for political change?” “Why might different stakeholders have differing perspectives about laws relating to free speech?”

- A1.6** evaluate and synthesize their findings to formulate conclusions and/or make informed judgements or predictions about the issues they are investigating

Sample questions: “Did the findings of your inquiry into this issue differ from your predictions? If so, in what way?” “What did you think were the most important facts that helped you reach your conclusions?” “What were the key ethical questions related to this issue? How have you approached them?” “Did the results of your inquiry help you develop a plan to address the issue?”

- A1.7** communicate their ideas, arguments, and conclusions using various formats and styles, as appropriate for the intended audience and purpose (e.g., a classroom presentation on an equity issue in Canada; a debate about a political issue, highlighting the perspectives of different stakeholders; a letter to an elected official requesting action on an issue of local importance; a web page highlighting the work of organizations that are addressing an issue of national or international importance; a dramatization of a town hall meeting on a political issue; a blog discussing local political issues and encouraging members of their community to become politically active)

- A1.8** use accepted forms of documentation (e.g., footnotes or endnotes, author/date citations, bibliographies, reference lists) to reference different types of sources (e.g., articles, blogs, books, films or videos, interviews with community members, songs, websites)

- A1.9** use appropriate terminology when communicating the results of their investigations (e.g., vocabulary specific to their topics; terms related to politics and to the concepts of political thinking)

A2. Developing Transferable Skills

Throughout this course, students will:

- A2.1** describe some ways in which political inquiry can help them develop skills, including the essential skills in the Ontario Skills Passport (e.g., skills related to reading texts, writing, document use, computer use, oral communication, numeracy, decision making, problem solving), and those related to the citizenship education framework,* that can be transferred to postsecondary opportunities, the world of work, and everyday life

- A2.2** demonstrate in everyday contexts attributes, skills, and work habits developed through investigations into issues of political importance (e.g., demonstrate attributes such as empathy and respect for other people; use listening and critical-thinking skills to engage in informed discussions, consider other points of view, and express informed opinions; use work habits such as working independently and taking initiative in a school project or their part-time job)

Sample question: “What are some ways in which you might demonstrate effective listening skills when people are voicing their position on an issue?”

- A2.3** apply the concepts of political thinking when analysing current events relating to issues of political importance at the local, national, and/or global level (e.g., an election result, a political protest, the release of a report by a government commission or a non-governmental organization [NGO] investigating a specific issue, an action taken by a political leader), in order to enhance their understanding of these issues and their role as informed citizens

Sample questions: “What people not mentioned in this news story are also affected by this issue?” “What are the stated objectives of this new parliamentary bill? What are some possible consequences that are not addressed by the proposed legislation?” “Why do you think this leader supports this specific position on this issue?”

- A2.4** identify some careers in which an understanding of politics and issues of political importance might be an asset (e.g., business person, fundraiser or lobbyist for an NGO or other activist group, journalist, member of Parliament, municipal or band councillor, policy adviser, social entrepreneur)

* The citizenship education framework appears on page 13.

B. FOUNDATIONS OF POLITICAL ENGAGEMENT

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1. Factors Affecting Political Engagement:** analyse how various factors can contribute to, and present a barrier to, their own and others' political engagement (**FOCUS ON:** *Political Significance; Political Perspective*)
- B2. Issues of Political Importance:** explain the political importance of some current issues and analyse various perspectives associated with these issues (**FOCUS ON:** *Political Significance; Political Perspective*)
- B3. Causes, Impact, and Solutions:** analyse some issues of political importance in terms of their causes, their impact, and ways in which they have been addressed (**FOCUS ON:** *Objectives and Results; Stability and Change*)

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

B1. Factors Affecting Political Engagement

FOCUS ON: *Political Significance; Political Perspective*

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1.1** identify some agents of political socialization (*e.g., the family, public education, religious institutions, the media, peers, personal experience, political/social organizations*), and analyse how these agents affect their own personal political beliefs and engagement and the beliefs and engagement of others

Sample questions: “Does your family’s political views and participation affect your own? To what extent do your friends and your education shape your political views and attitudes? What facets of your personal identity affect your political orientation?” “What methods do the media use to try to shape the political views and attitudes of teenagers?” “Which groups tend to have the highest rates of political participation in Canada? How would you account for these patterns?”

- B1.2** describe their own personal attitudes towards political engagement, including the extent and type of involvement they think appropriate (*e.g., non-involvement, donating to charities, volunteering locally, participating in “voluntourism”, keeping informed, making their views known to those in power, engaging in political protest, joining a political party*)

Sample questions: “What is the relationship between your own beliefs and values and your level of political involvement?” “Do you think it is important to understand political issues within different communities? Why or why not? What are some ways in which you could enhance your understanding of these issues?” “Is there a ‘right time’ to get involved in a political issue? How do you determine when to get involved in an issue at school, in your neighbourhood, or elsewhere?”

- B1.3** describe some challenges or barriers to political engagement (*e.g., with reference to economic factors, gender, level of education, accessibility, social status or power, discrimination, personal experience and attitudes, personality traits, emotional state*)

Sample questions: “What relationship do you see between socio-economic status and political leadership?” “Why are fewer women than men involved in political leadership?” “How are young people encouraged to take part, or discouraged from taking part, in political action?” “What are cynicism and apathy? How might these qualities affect a person’s level of political engagement?” “How might certain personality traits inhibit a person’s desire and/or ability to advocate for political change?”

- B1.4** describe personal attributes, attitudes, and skills that enhance an individual’s ability to be a responsible citizen and contribute to the

common good (e.g., respect for others, perseverance, capacity for empathy, willingness to lead or take initiative, collaborative skills, oral communication skills, organizational skills)

Sample questions: “In what ways do you believe you demonstrate the attributes of a responsible citizen? In what areas do you think you could improve?” “Do you believe that your approach/attitude enables you to address this political issue in a constructive way?” “How might your peers help you with a personal growth plan that might enhance the qualities needed for responsible citizenship?”

- B1.5** explain, with reference to the perspectives of bystanders and upstanders, why people choose to take action on, or not get involved in, political issues (e.g., bystanders may be apathetic or fearful, may feel powerless, or may not feel strongly about the issue at hand; upstanders may be highly motivated by their sense of justice and concern for others or may be personally affected by the issue), and analyse possible consequences of both stands

Sample questions: “What arguments can be made in favour of intervention by private citizens in cases of perceived wrongdoing? What arguments can be made against such intervention?” “Why do Canadians respond quickly to sudden disasters such as earthquakes and tsunamis but less reliably to long-term disasters such as famine and drought or long-term challenges such as climate change? What are some of the consequences of these patterns?” “Why might Canadians be more generous with international communities in need than with those living in poverty within their own borders?”

B2. Issues of Political Importance

FOCUS ON: *Political Significance; Political Perspective*

By the end of this course, students will:

- B2.1** explain the political importance of some current local, national, and/or global issues (e.g., issues related to bullying in schools and/or cyberbullying, public transit, food security, substandard housing in some First Nations communities, water and/or energy conservation, disaster relief and/or development aid, working conditions in sweatshops, child soldiers, human rights abuses, climate change, the AIDS pandemic, violence against women, social and/or economic inequality)

Sample questions: “Why are some issues politically important while others tend to be ignored? What are some factors that have increased the profile of certain issues and

contributed to their political importance?” “Why has cyberbullying become a political issue?” “Why might evidence of increasing use of food banks in Canadian communities contribute to the political importance of the issue of poverty in Canada?” “How and why has the question of where clothing is made, and the working conditions of those making it, become a political issue?”

- B2.2** identify criteria that could be used to rank issues in order of their political priority (e.g., the number of people affected; how long people have been waiting for a solution; whether the issue involves basic human needs; whether human rights are being violated; having the means and/or authority to respond; the social, economic, and/or environmental impact of an issue)

Sample questions: “Which criteria do you think should be given the most emphasis when ranking issues?” “Is the political priority given an issue always an accurate reflection of the issue’s actual importance?” “In what ways might the relative power of the people affected by or concerned with an issue affect its political priority?”

- B2.3** analyse the positions of different stakeholders concerned with some issues of political importance (e.g., those directly affected, upstanders or advocates, bystanders, non-governmental and intergovernmental organizations, governments, business)

Sample questions: “What concerns might different individuals and groups have about the location of a half-way house?” “Why would people choose to cooperate with or not get involved in a police investigation?” “Why might a municipal government or band council have a different position than a provincial government on a transportation plan?” “What are some arguments made by different groups in response to proposals to raise or lower taxes?” “Why might First Nations people and cottagers take different positions on water conservation or protection?”

B3. Causes, Impact, and Solutions

FOCUS ON: *Objectives and Results; Stability and Change*

By the end of this course, students will:

- B3.1** analyse the causes of some issues of political importance and how an understanding of these causes can affect the action taken to address the issues

Sample questions: “How have factors such as gender inequality, poverty, global apathy, lack

of access to health care and prescription drugs, unsafe sexual practices, cultural norms and beliefs, and lack of access to education contributed to the HIV/AIDS pandemic in sub-Saharan Africa? How would you rank these factors in order of importance? Why would your ranking affect your view of the type of action that is needed most urgently?" "Why might a First Nation community have a boil water advisory while a non-indigenous community in the same region has access to clean water?"

B3.2 analyse the impact of some issues of political importance, with a particular emphasis on issues related to equity, human rights, and/or the environment (*e.g., homelessness, child poverty, growing economic inequality, foreign aid, free speech, accessibility issues, refugee crises, discrimination against girls and women in many countries, urban sprawl, carbon emissions, climate change, protection of water*)

Sample questions: "What is the difference between equity and equality?" "Why are people concerned about growing economic inequality, both in Canada and globally? What impact does such inequality have on individuals? On governments? On societies?" "Why are a number of international development organizations directing their aid towards girls and women?" "What is the economic impact of the development of the Alberta oil sands? What is its environmental impact?"

B3.3 identify actions that have been taken to address some issues of political importance, and assess the effectiveness of these actions in achieving the intended objective

Sample questions: "What problems were some provinces hoping to solve by adopting the harmonized sales tax (HST)? Did the adoption of the HST solve these problems?" "What is the purpose of the Kyoto Protocol? How effective has it been in achieving its objective?" "What are some political policies and/or actions taken by organizations that have been intended to address the issue of homelessness? How effective have they been?" "What actions has the current government taken to improve job prospects for youth? Have these programs been successful? What criteria would you use to make that judgement?"

C. POLICY, POLITICS, AND DEMOCRATIC CHANGE

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1. The Influence of Individuals and Groups:** analyse the objectives and strategies, and assess the influence, of individuals and groups in addressing issues of political importance (**FOCUS ON:** *Objectives and Results; Political Perspective*)
- C2. Law and Policy in Canada:** analyse the impact of some key changes in Canadian law and policy as well as the process for changing laws in Canada (**FOCUS ON:** *Objectives and Results; Stability and Change*)
- C3. Political Change in Democratic Societies:** demonstrate an understanding of factors that facilitate and present challenges to democratic political change (**FOCUS ON:** *Political Significance; Political Perspective*)

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

C1. The Influence of Individuals and Groups

FOCUS ON: *Objectives and Results; Political Perspective*

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1.1** analyse some of the political objectives of various heads of government, both historical and current (e.g., *Fidel Castro, Adolf Hitler, Nelson Mandela, Barack Obama, Pol Pot, Joseph Stalin, Margaret Thatcher, Pierre Trudeau*), and assess their use of power and strategies for achieving their goals

Sample questions: “What are some basic differences between democratic and non-democratic political leaders in the way they gain, maintain, and/or share power? Is non-democratic leadership always an abuse of power?” “What criteria can be used to determine whether the strategies used by those in power are ethical?” “What arguments might dictators use to justify their regimes? What are some common methods they use to gain and keep political power?”
- C1.2** explain the role of various individuals and groups in Canada in changing specific laws or policies, and assess the significance of the changes (e.g., *Henry Morgentaler and abortion laws, Mothers Against Drunk Driving [MADD] and drunk driving legislation, Sabrina Shannon and Sabrina’s Law on anaphylaxis policy in*

Ontario schools, Shannen Koostachin and Shannen’s Dream for equitable school funding in First Nations communities, Donald Marshall and changes to Canada’s Evidence Act)

Sample question: “What role did Mary Two-Axe Early play in changing sections of the Indian Act that discriminated against status Indian women who married non-status men?”

- C1.3** describe the main goals and strategies of some individuals and groups/movements that have brought about and/or are attempting to bring about greater socio-political equality, and assess their effectiveness (e.g., *Viola Desmond, Mohandas Gandhi, Elijah Harper, Martin Luther King, Naomi Klein, Elizabeth May, Nellie McClung; the women’s rights, civil rights, Aboriginal rights, disability rights, or gay rights movement; the Occupy movement; movements for democratic change in Egypt, Myanmar, or China*)

Sample questions: “What are the main political goals of Aboriginal rights groups in Canada? What strategies have they used to support these goals? What challenges do they face in achieving these goals?”
- C1.4** analyse the role of the media in influencing political change (e.g., *through public opinion polls, political advertising, news stories, gatekeeping*)

Sample questions: “Do you think media are objective reporters on issues of political

importance?" "How have advances in communications technology and the rise of social media influenced local, national, and global politics? What was the role of social media in the Egyptian revolution of 2011?" "What regulations does the Canada Elections Act place on how broadcasters cover elections in Canada? Is such regulation necessary? Why or why not?" "What types of advertising do political parties use to influence voters? What are the objectives of the different types of political advertising? Which types do you think are most effective, and why?"

C2. Law and Policy in Canada

FOCUS ON: *Objectives and Results; Stability and Change*

By the end of this course, students will:

C2.1 describe how various provisions of the Canadian Charter of Rights and Freedoms and the Ontario Human Rights Code have both produced and reflected societal change in Canada (*e.g., in invalidating laws and practices that permit unequal treatment for individuals in areas such as employment and access to services on the basis of race, sex, sexual orientation, religion, physical disability, and so on*)

Sample questions: "How has Ontario's Human Rights Code influenced legislation related to physical accessibility standards in the province?" "How does the Canadian Charter of Rights and Freedoms support recent immigrants to Canada?" "What social change do you think may occur as a result of the Ontario Human Rights Commission decision that an employer's demand for 'Canadian work experience' can result in discrimination?"

C2.2 analyse some key policy changes that have contributed to equity in Canada (*e.g., closing residential schools, establishing medicare, enshrining gender in the Charter, mandating accessibility for disabled people, laws recognizing same-sex marriage, official apologies to some groups who faced discriminatory treatment*) and the political processes involved in achieving these changes

Sample questions: "In what ways were people of Chinese origin in Canada discriminated against in the nineteenth and twentieth centuries? What legislative and/or policy changes were required to end the discrimination? What political processes were involved in making these changes?" "What factors contributed to the government's apology for Indian residential

schools? Do you think this apology has contributed to equity in Canada? Why or why not?" "What are some government programs that are available to provide assistance to people with low incomes? What political processes were involved in establishing these programs?"

C2.3 describe the process for amending an existing law or passing a new law in Canada

Sample questions: "Is there a current law that you think needs to be amended? What types of changes do you think need to be made? Have people tried to amend this law in the past? Why do you think they were unsuccessful? What obstacles need to be overcome in order to ensure success?" "What are some major changes to financial legislation in Canada in the past century? How were these changes enacted?"

C3. Political Change in Democratic Societies

FOCUS ON: *Political Significance; Political Perspective*

By the end of this course, students will:

C3.1 describe some key characteristics of a democracy (*e.g., rule of law, respect for the common good, social responsibility, freedom of expression*), and explain how they affect the practice of making political change

Sample questions: "What is the rule of law and why is it important in a democracy?" "Does a democratic political system necessarily ensure political equality? What impact can the unequal distribution of political power have on political change related to human rights or the environment?" "What impact does non-participation of citizens have on a democracy?" "Why is political change necessary for a democracy?"

C3.2 identify various skills and strategies that can be used when seeking political change in democratic societies, and assess their effectiveness (*e.g., skills related to conflict resolution, leadership, persuasive speaking/writing, digital literacy, consensus building, critical and creative thinking; strategies such as civil discourse, civil disobedience, organizing and mobilizing citizens, demonstrations/marches, boycotts, pressuring politicians to change laws/policies, fundraising, raising awareness*)

Sample questions: "What are some strategies that lesbian, gay, bisexual, and transgender (LGBT) communities have used when seeking political change? Why might the strategies used in Canada be different from those used in some

other societies?" "Why was the Green Party created? How effective do you think it has been in securing political change with respect to environmental issues?" "How have technological developments such as social media affected the strategies of groups seeking political change? Do you think the use of social media can enhance the effectiveness of such groups? Why or why not?"

C3.3 analyse a current political issue to identify factors that could facilitate or obstruct efforts to reach a solution (*e.g.*, facilitating factors: *public accountability processes, community support, leadership support*; obstructing factors: *"not in my backyard" opposition, lack of awareness or consensus, a focus on negative consequences, lack of money and resources, resistance from powerful groups*)

Sample questions: "Why might some people support an idea in theory but take a 'not in my backyard' approach to it in practice?" "What are the biggest barriers to change in your community?"

D. PERSONAL ACTION ON A POLITICAL ISSUE

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- D1. Investigating an Issue:** identify and analyse a political issue, with the goal of developing a personal plan of action to address this issue (**FOCUS ON:** *Political Significance; Political Perspective*)
- D2. Developing a Plan of Action:** identify a goal associated with the selected issue and construct an action plan to achieve that goal (**FOCUS ON:** *Objectives and Results; Political Perspective*)
- D3. Considering Outcomes:** analyse and reflect on possible outcome(s) of their plan (**FOCUS ON:** *Objectives and Results; Stability and Change*)

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

D1. Investigating an Issue

FOCUS ON: *Political Significance; Political Perspective*

By the end of this course, students will:

- D1.1** identify a political issue that is of personal interest and that it is possible to address through a personal plan of action
Sample questions: “What is a general political issue that is particularly important to you? Why do you think it is important to address this issue? Is there an aspect of this issue that you could address through a personal plan of action?”
- D1.2** analyse the selected issue, including how it is viewed by key stakeholders, and clarify their own position on the issue
Sample questions: “Where can you find reliable information about this issue? How can you ensure that the information you find addresses the issue from the perspective of different stakeholders?” “Who are the main stakeholders and what are their positions and concerns? Which stakeholder’s position most closely reflects your own?”

D2. Developing a Plan of Action

FOCUS ON: *Objectives and Results; Political Perspective*

By the end of this course, students will:

- D2.1** identify and describe the intended goal relating to the selected issue and explain the reasons for choosing that goal
Sample questions: “What is your goal?” “Is your goal based on an informed analysis of the issue?” “Have you considered your goal through an ethical lens?” “Have you taken into account factors that might make your goal difficult to achieve as well as factors that make it feasible?” “How does your goal take the common good into account?”
- D2.2** identify several possible courses of action that could be used to address the issue and achieve their goal (e.g., *an awareness campaign using a variety of media, including social media; public service messages; a submission or deputation to the relevant level and area of government; a protest campaign; a fundraising campaign*), and analyse the benefits and costs associated with each
Sample questions: “Which course of action would likely have the greatest impact?” “Does one course of action require more funding than the others?” “Is there a course of action that

could be accomplished more readily than the others?" "Which action would be the most effective to implement?" "Does your course of action take into consideration all groups that are affected by your plan? If not, who is excluded? What are the implications of this exclusion?"

D2.3 identify the most appropriate course of action based on their analysis of the possible options and create a detailed action plan, specifying the steps needed to implement the plan (e.g., *developing a detailed communications plan; identifying sources of support, including financial support; creating visuals; writing letters; presenting a theatre performance; producing and distributing an information poster; developing a website*)

Sample questions: "Which people and organizations should you target with your letter-writing campaign?" "What interest group or level of government might provide funding to support this initiative?" "Who could you collaborate with in your course of action?"

D2.4 identify key skills needed to implement the proposed plan (e.g., *skills relating to setting and revising goals; organization; collaboration; communication; technology; management, including media management skills and the ability to conduct effective meetings*)

Sample questions: "What are some techniques for encouraging participation in a meeting while keeping the discussion on track?" "How do you decide when and to whom to delegate responsibility for specific tasks?" "What resources are available to help you improve your implementation skills?"

D3. Considering Outcomes

FOCUS ON: *Objectives and Results; Stability and Change*

By the end of this course, students will:

D3.1 identify criteria that could be used in evaluating the success of their action plan

Sample questions: "What changes would you expect to see if your action plan were completely successful? Partially successful? Of the possible changes, which would be most important or desirable to achieve?"

D3.2 identify key learning from their inquiry and formulate further questions and possible next steps

Sample questions: "What have you learned from developing your action plan that you could apply in other areas of political activity? Did what you have learned change your approach to this issue in any way?" "What are some ways in which you might build on your action plan?"